Functions

1. S-Adenosylmethionine(SAM) acts as a methyl group donor for certain enzymes.
2. Sulphur containing amino acids are responsible for structural maintenance of proteins like insulin and keratin.
3. It is present in compounds like acetyl CoA and succinyl CoA which are needed for various reactions.
4. Glutathione is a valuable sulphur containing Tripeptide needed for the detoxification of H_2O_2.
5. Sulphur is present in heteropolysaccharides like heparin, a natural anti-coagulant.

Sources



Figure 9.10 sources of sulphur

Sulphur intake is mainly in the form of cysteine and methionine present in protein. Adequate protein in diet fulfills sulphur requirement.

Absorption and excretion:

Inorganic sulphate (SO_4^{2-}) is absorbed as such from the intestine into the portal circulation. Sulphur is excreted in the urine.

Deficiency

Specific sulphur deficiency state has not been reported in human beings.

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